

PLAIN LANGUAGE • EVERY CHAPTER OF LIFE

the money map.

whatever you're going through, it starts in the same place. **footing that's yours. your chapter's first three steps. a job for every dollar.** start anywhere — done beats perfect.

01

your footing

five things in your name

02

your chapter

the first three steps

03

your split

where every dollar goes

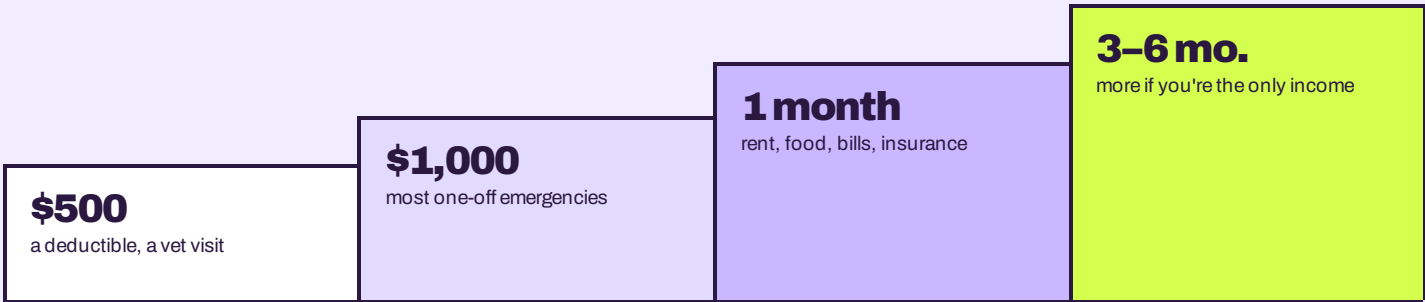
01

first, get your own footing.

five things that should be in your name at every stage. check them off one at a time, smallest first.

1	an account that's yours alone money you can reach without asking anyone. the most important line in this guide.	DO THIS open checking or savings in your name only, at a bank you picked. send part of every paycheck there.
2	copies of your documents proof of who you are, ready in an afternoon.	DO THIS ID, passport, social security card, birth certificate, tax returns, lease or deed, insurance — stored where only you can reach.
3	a cushion that's yours so a surprise — or a change — happens on your terms.	DO THIS build it in stages (below) in a high-yield savings account in your name.
4	credit in your own name a score that's yours, not borrowed from someone else's card.	DO THIS be the primary on one card, autopay the full balance, check free reports at annualcreditreport.com .
5	one number you know what comes in, what goes out, what you're worth.	DO THIS write down take-home, essentials, and net worth (own minus owe). check it once a month.

THE CUSHION, IN STAGES — EACH STEP IS A REAL WIN



02 your first three steps.

whatever you're going through, find your chapter below. do step 1 this week — the rest can wait until you're ready.

SOMETHING'S ENDING

i'm getting divorced

- 1 copy every statement + 3 years of tax returns
- 2 open an account in your name only; pull your credit report
- 3 list what you own and owe; check beneficiaries before signing

SOMETHING'S ENDING

i need to leave — quietly

- 1 safety first: call 800-799-7233 or text START to 88788
- 2 copy your documents; keep them where only you can reach
- 3 start money that's only yours — even \$20 at a time

SOMETHING'S ENDING

my partner died

- 1 most big decisions can wait a few months
- 2 order several certified death certificates
- 3 call social security about survivor benefits

STARTING NEW

i'm going back to work

- 1 write down what you did while away — it counts
- 2 know your number before the first interview
- 3 negotiate the first offer; every raise builds on it

STARTING NEW

i'm starting over from zero

- 1 an account in your name + your free credit reports
- 2 build credit on purpose: a secured card, paid in full
- 3 cushion in stages: \$500 → \$1,000 → one month

STARTING NEW

i'm starting a business

- 1 test the idea; separate business money from day one
- 2 sole proprietor or LLC, plus a free EIN from the IRS
- 3 set aside ~25–30% of what you earn for taxes

TAKING CARE

i'm raising kids on my own

- 1 file head of household; up to \$2,200 per child
- 2 name a guardian in a will; check beneficiaries
- 3 build a bigger cushion — you're the only income

IT JUST HAPPENED

i came into money

- 1 park it in high-yield savings; wait 30 days
- 2 pay off high-interest debt first
- 3 then decide — with a fee-only advisor if it's big

more chapters — first job, first lease, a job offer, caring for a parent, a surprise bill, divorcing after 50 — each with links to go deeper.

multiplata.com/start.html →

03

give every dollar a job before it disappears.

bend the split to your life — but bend joy first, never future-you.

EVERY PAYCHECK

a \$3,000 month → \$1,500 · \$900 · \$600

50% now rent, food, bills, insurance	30% future-you cushion, debt, investing	20% joy fun, travel
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EXTRA MONEY — BONUS, REFUND, GIFT

a windfall? see below first.

50% future-you debt, safety, investing	30% a real goal a course, a move	20% fun yes, really
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THE ORDER OF OPERATIONS

- 1**
payday
move future-you money first, automatically. what's left is yours.
- 2**
the cushion
fill \$500 → \$1,000 before anything else in future-you.
- 3**
the fire
pay down high-interest debt. that interest outruns almost any investment.
- 4**
the growth
invest: any employer 401(k) match, then a Roth IRA.

windfall? park it in high-yield savings and give yourself 30 days. then kill high-interest debt, then use the "extra money" split.

YOUR SPLIT one number each.	\$ _____ now	\$ _____ future-you	\$ _____ joy
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there's a whole library behind this map.

every chapter, every word decoded — free, plain language, nothing to sell you.

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